



R. RAGU

was not utilised even when the home team had to bowl close to 120 overs in the second Test in Delhi. In Ahmedabad, Jurel scored his hundred after walking in at No.5, while Reddy was left unused at No.8.

Since his debut against England in early 2024, Jurel has looked increasingly secure. Batting in the

lower middle order, he displayed a mature balance between defence and attack. Earlier, he built his innings by alternating between the two. The West Indies series revealed another layer — the ability to rotate strike without taking undue risks. It showed how much he has evolved as a Test batter in just seven matches.

“He has become settled now. When a player knows he’ll be in the squad, he plays with a free mind,” Jurel’s childhood coach Phool Chand told *Sportstar*.

Jurel now bats with calm assurance and range, capable of playing every shot in the book. His 125 in the Ahmedabad Test proved